MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検2級
リーディングトレーニング

第3回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検2級形式のリーディング第3回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) The pharmaceutical firm had to ( ) three thousand bottles of cough syrup after a labeling error was found.

1 recite **2** recall **3** recruit **4** recede

(2) Even minor delays at one major hub airport can have a ( ) effect on flight schedules across the country.

1 rigid **2** random **3** ripple **4** rustic

(3) To keep the discussion productive, the chairperson asked speakers to ( ) their remarks to five minutes.

1 confine **2** confer **3** conform **4** confess

(4) At first glance the old wooden barn looked ordinary, yet its interior beams were ( ) carved with floral patterns.

1 impulsively **2** indifferently **3** intricately **4** insufficiently

(5) The town's water supply remained stable throughout August, ( ) the investments made in leak detection last year.

1 aside from **2** contrary to **3** regardless of **4** thanks to

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) When negotiations stalled over delivery dates, an experienced mediator stepped in to break the (　　).

1 deadline　**2** deadlock　**3** downturn　**4** drawback

(7) Only after the sensor batteries were replaced (　　) the weather station begin transmitting accurate wind data again.

1 did　**2** had　**3** was　**4** would

(8) Local fishermen agreed to limit their catch this season lest young sea bream stocks (　　) further.

1 flourish　**2** prevail　**3** multiply　**4** dwindle

(9) Although electric cargo bikes cannot carry heavy steel beams, they are well (　　) to last-mile parcel deliveries in narrow lanes.

1 subjected　**2** submitted　**3** suited　**4** subscribed

(10) The editor praised the reporter's article for remaining strictly (　　) rather than taking sides in the neighborhood dispute.

1 impartial　**2** impatient　**3** immature　**4** immense

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(11) Having lived in a tropical port for a decade, Mr. Diaz is thoroughly (　　) with how monsoon winds shift in June.

1 accompanied　**2** acquainted　**3** accustomed　**4** accounted

(12) The hiking club carries a portable tarp on autumn trips as a (　　) against sudden mountain showers.

1 prediction　**2** precaution　**3** privilege　**4** proportion

(13) Far from making human proofreaders (　　), automated spell-checkers have freed them to focus on tone and factual clarity.

1 reluctant　**2** resilient　**3** respectful　**4** redundant

(14) Visitors may sketch in the sculpture gallery with pencils, (　　) they do not block walkways or use ink pens.

1 unless　**2** whereas　**3** provided　**4** despite

(15) The town's volunteer fire brigade conducts joint drills twice a year so that coordination becomes second (　　).

1 nature　**2** sense　**3** sight　**4** thought

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(16) The ceramics exhibition was extended by two weeks in response to (　　) demand from weekday visitors.

1 overlapping　**2** overlooking　**3** overturning　**4** overwhelming

(17) Scientists caution against drawing sweeping conclusions from a single survey, as small samples are (　　) to random variation.

1 prone　**2** prior　**3** plain　**4** proud

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Designing Hospital Signs Under Stress

Designing directional signs for an airport or mall is challenging, yet hospitals present an even stricter test. Visitors arriving for urgent appointments are often anxious, tired, or unfamiliar with medical terms. A sign pointing to "Otolaryngology" may be technically exact while leaving an elderly patient standing helplessly in the lobby.

When a regional medical center renovated its main building, planners shadowed first-time visitors from the bus stop to exam rooms. People rarely read long wall directories from top to bottom; instead, they looked for one simple cue at each junction. Pairing formal department names with everyday terms—such as "Ear, Nose & Throat"—immediately reduced hesitation. (18), colored stripes along the baseboard reassured visitors that they were still on the right path.

Testing also revealed a placement flaw. Designers had hung overhead panels near the ceiling, yet people pushing wheelchairs or strollers looked straight ahead and walked right under them. Lowering markers to eye level on corner pillars solved the problem. (19), consistent icons—such as a teacup for the cafeteria and a mortar for the pharmacy—helped residents still learning the local language.

Arriving without getting lost lowered visitors' stress before they met a doctor, proving that (20).

(18)

1 Nevertheless
2 Likewise
3 Otherwise
4 In contrast

(19)

1 Instead
2 Previously
3 Furthermore
4 Regardless

(20)

1 thoughtful spatial communication is part of patient care itself
2 medical terms should never appear anywhere in a hospital
3 ceiling signs are always superior to wall markers
4 visitors prefer getting directions only through smartphone apps

Why Urban Bakeries Mill Grain Freshly Again

For most of the twentieth century, small bakeries bought bags of refined white flour milled months earlier at large industrial plants. Removing the grain's outer bran and oil-rich germ gave white flour a shelf life of nearly a year, allowing predictable dough behavior in every season. However, stripping away the germ also removed aromatic oils and minerals that give wheat its distinct regional character.

Over the past decade, a growing number of neighborhood bakers have installed compact stone mills in a corner of their kitchens to grind whole grain just days before baking. Freshly milled flour behaves very differently from aged commercial flour. Because natural oils and enzymes are still active, doughs ferment faster and absorb water differently depending on the harvest weather. Bakers cannot follow a fixed clock; they must judge dough elasticity by touch and adjust water temperature batch by batch. (21), switching to fresh flour requires retraining staff accustomed to uniform ingredients.

Despite the extra skill involved, direct milling has created unexpected partnerships between city bakeries and nearby farms. Industrial mills typically blend grain from vast regions to guarantee identical protein levels, leaving little market for a farmer growing five hectares of a flavorful heritage wheat. Small bakeries, by contrast, can buy a single farm's harvest and celebrate subtle year-to-year differences on their chalkboard menus. (22), farmers gain a stable local buyer willing to pay for flavor rather than sheer volume.

Freshly stone-ground loaves will probably remain a craft specialty rather than replace industrial bread altogether. Even so, these kitchens show that (23) can revive both culinary flavor and regional agriculture.

(21)

1 On the other hand
2 Until then
3 Consequently
4 Surprisingly

(22)

1 Otherwise
2 Nevertheless
3 For instance
4 In return

(23)

1 storing white flour for several years before baking
2 shortening the distance between grain, miller, and baker
3 eliminating all whole-grain bread from city menus
4 forcing small farms to blend their crops in giant plants

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Volunteer Shift Adjustments for the Harbor Clean-Up

From: T. Honda, Coastal Conservation Network
To: Sunday Clean-Up Volunteers
Subject: Tide schedule change and sorting rules for October 18

Dear volunteers,
Thank you for signing up for Sunday's harbor and breakwater clean-up. Because autumn spring tides will bring the lowest water level at 8:15 a.m. rather than mid-morning, we are moving check-in thirty minutes earlier to 7:30 a.m. Starting early gives us a safe ninety-minute window to collect tangled fishing line and plastic from the rocky tide pools before the water rises again. Volunteers who rely on the first ferry from East Island—which arrives at 8:05 a.m.—may join Group C along the upper promenade, where tide height is not a factor.

This year, marine biology students from the prefectural university will record the types of ropes and buoys we recover so local cooperatives can identify gear that breaks loose most often. Please place intact buoys and numbered net tags into the blue crates rather than crushing them into general trash bags.

Thick rubber-palmed gloves and steel tongs will be handed out at check-in, but you must wear sturdy closed-toe shoes with non-slip soles; sandals and canvas sneakers are not allowed on wet rocks. If you come across sealed chemical drums or flares, do not touch them—mark the spot with an orange flag from your group leader's kit and alert harbor staff.

Warm regards,
T. Honda

Volunteer Shift Adjustments for the Harbor Clean-Up — Questions

(24) Why has the volunteer check-in time been moved earlier?

1 To finish the entire event before the first ferry arrives.

2 Because university students must return to campus by 8:30 a.m.

3 To take advantage of early low tide safely before water levels rise.

4 To avoid strong afternoon sunlight on the upper promenade.

(25) Why should intact buoys and numbered net tags be placed in blue crates?

1 So they can be sold to tourists at the harbor market.

2 So university students can catalog them to help identify gear that often breaks loose.

3 Because general trash bags tear when wet.

4 Because only harbor staff are allowed to carry general trash bags.

(26) What should volunteers do if they find a sealed chemical drum?

1 Carry it carefully to the blue crates using steel tongs.

2 Open the lid slightly to check whether it is empty.

3 Push it into a deep tide pool away from walkers.

4 Leave it untouched, mark the location with an orange flag, and inform harbor staff.

Why Reintroducing Beavers Changes Whole Valleys

When ecologists talk about restoring damaged river valleys, attention often centers on concrete engineering: digging drainage channels, reinforcing banks with stone, or building small check dams to slow floodwaters. Over the past twenty years, however, watershed managers across Europe and North America have increasingly turned to an unexpected partner—the Eurasian and North American beaver, rodents that were hunted to near extinction in many regions centuries ago.

Unlike human-built concrete weirs, which block a stream with a single rigid wall, beaver dams are leaky lattices of branches, mud, and stones. During heavy rain, water seeps slowly through dozens of small gaps and spreads sideways into shallow ponds and marshy meadows rather than rushing downstream all at once. Hydrological studies monitoring streams before and after beaver relocation have recorded markedly lower flood peaks downstream, while water stored in surrounding soil continues feeding the stream during dry late-summer weeks.

These messy wetlands transform biodiversity as well. Dead wood and slow-moving pools shelter aquatic insects, which in turn feed juvenile trout and frogs; herons, kingfishers, and bats soon follow. Moreover, sediment and excess agricultural nutrients settle to the bottom of beaver ponds instead of washing straight into coastal bays, improving water clarity farther down the river.

Coexisting with industrious rodents is not friction-free, of course. Left unchecked in flat farmland, beavers may fell prized orchard trees or plug road culverts, flooding rural lanes and crop corners. Successful reintroduction programs therefore devote as much effort to practical conflict tools as to animal biology. Wrapping vulnerable tree trunks with wire mesh takes minutes, and installing simple perforated pipes—often called "pond levelers"—through a dam lets landowners cap water height quietly without triggering the beavers' instinct to repair a breach.

Ultimately, beaver restoration works best not as a hands-off wilderness fantasy, but as a negotiated partnership in working landscapes. Where communities prepare practical safeguards in advance, a leaky wooden dam can deliver flood buffering and wetland habitat at a fraction of the cost of poured concrete.

Why Reintroducing Beavers Changes Whole Valleys — Questions

(27) How do beaver dams reduce flooding differently from rigid concrete weirs?

1 Their leaky branch structure slows water and spreads it into side ponds and soil.

2 They evaporate rainwater instantly before it touches the ground.

3 They divert all river water into underground steel pipes.

4 They stand ten meters higher than municipal flood walls.

(28) Besides slowing floodwaters, what environmental benefit of beaver ponds is described in the third paragraph?

1 They warm river water enough for tropical fish to survive winter.

2 They trap sediment and excess farm nutrients, improving downstream water clarity.

3 They eliminate all insects from nearby meadows.

4 They turn salty ocean water into fresh drinking water.

(29) What problem can occur when beavers live near flat farmland without management?

1 They may cut down valued trees or block road drainage pipes.

2 They dig up paved highways to build stone burrows.

3 They chase livestock out of barns at night.

4 They drain all moisture from agricultural soil in spring.

(30) How does a "pond leveler" pipe help resolve conflicts with landowners?

1 It scares beavers into moving to another river valley.

2 It filters mud into dry bricks for farm buildings.

3 It controls maximum water height without prompting beavers to patch the dam.

4 It plays recorded predator sounds whenever water rises.

(31) Which statement best captures the author's overall view of beaver reintroduction?

1 Beavers should only be released in remote mountains where no humans live.

2 Concrete engineering is always cheaper and greener than biological restoration.

3 Once beavers arrive in a valley, human communities should never intervene again.

4 With practical conflict-prevention tools, humans and beavers can coexist to benefit whole watersheds.